Social Media: Custom Fonts

Inclusion Toolkit

What is it for?

People often use generator websites to make their text look unique (for example, 𝒸𝓊𝓇𝓈𝒾𝓋𝑒 [the word cursive, in fancy script letters] or 𝕓𝕠𝕝𝕕 [the word bold, in outlined letters]). However, these are not real fonts. They are mathematical symbols from the Unicode standard designed for equations, not language.

When a screen reader encounters this text, it does not read the word. It reads the mathematical description of every single character. 𝐻𝑒𝓁𝓁𝑜 ("Hello") becomes "Mathematical script capital H, mathematical script small e..." which makes the message impossible to understand.

How to support it

The kindest thing you can do is avoid these generators entirely for your display name, profile description, and post text.

- Use the default keyboard font provided by the platform. This ensures your text is readable and searchable.
- Since you cannot use bold or italics on most apps, capitalise the first letter of key words (not whole words) instead.

Useful Links

Accessible Social: Just Not My Type, on why fancy text generators cause problems